

Learn how to use Excel

This may seem funny at first, but very few people realize how hopeless they are at using an excel sheet. Sure, they may be able to put in numbers in one cell and letters in the other, but the only time this software is used to its maximum potential is when the user knows how to create his own formulae and tabulate data to use Excel the way it's meant to be used instead of an easy way to print tables. There are high-flying professionals out there in every field - media, event management, brand managers, producers, agents - who know what a f/1.4 10-20mm EF-mount lens is, but can't tell a =SUM function apart from a =TEXT function. Knowing Excel can make the difference between acing a job interview and failing miserably.

Media editing

Knowing how to fiddle with Audio and Video equipment is always a plus point in Arts-related careers. Artists need to be photographed, singers need to be heard, writers need to be read. Since the advent of the digital era, it's always handy to know your way around audio and video editing software. It's fun, and a definite plus point from the point of view of employers. There are a few software out there used by the industry as a whole.

Although most editors prefer the Adobe Creative Suite (though the Apple fanboys swear by Final Cut Pro), Avid (<https://www.avid.com/US/>) is the industry standard for video editing. On the audio side, Nuendo (<http://digit.in/ficrtnd>) is also a favourite. Easy to use, with great tools, it's extensively used for good digital multitrack performance on radio shows.

When it comes to image editing, Adobe takes the cake with its Photoshop (<http://digit.in/ficrtps>) software, which rarely needs introduction.

To get a preliminary grasp at the basics for any of these software (or the several dozens of other software), YouTube has several tutorials to keep you busy. The channel PhotoVideoEditing (<http://digit.in/ficrtpe>) is a good place to start. As for the software themselves, most of them are quite pricey especially if you want to use them to their full potential. There are



Avid is widely used in the movie industry